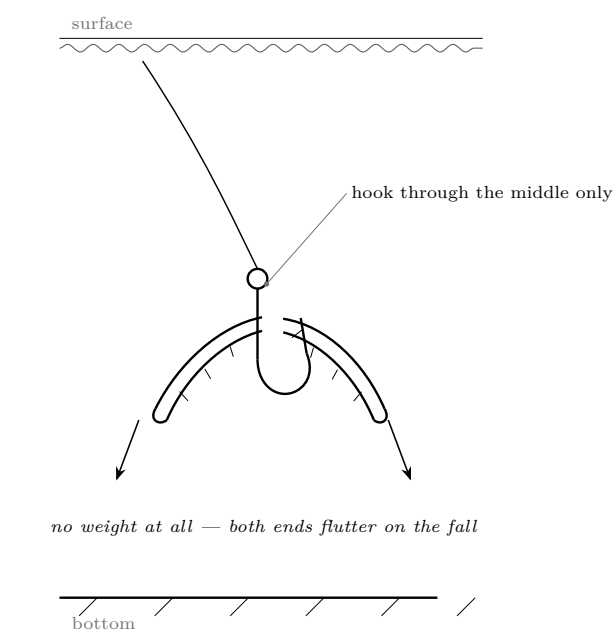




- What it does

A straight soft-plastic worm hooked through its middle, with no weight at all. On the fall both halves shimmy independently. Nothing else in fishing moves like it.
- Why it works

It falls slowly, horizontally, and looks alive while doing nothing. In water as clear as Pine Lake’s, a slow horizontal fall beats an active retrieve.
- Components

One 1/0 or 2/0 octopus or wide-gap hook, one 5 in stick worm. That is the entire rig.
- O-ring

Slide a small rubber O-ring onto the worm’s middle and hook under the ring instead of through the plastic. One worm then lasts twenty fish instead of two.
- Line

6–10 lb. Spinning tackle. Fluorocarbon leader on Pine Lake.
- Catches

Largemouth above all; smallmouth and big bluegill will take it too.

Fish it

1. Cast past the target — a dock, a weed clump, an edge — and **do nothing**.
2. Watch the line. The worm is falling on a slack line and almost every bite happens here. If the line twitches, jumps, or stops falling, reel down and sweep.
3. If it reaches the bottom untouched, give the rod two small shakes, then let it sit for a slow count of five.
4. Lift, let it fall again, and repeat. Retrieve slowly and cast again.

Getting it right

- Patience

The single most common mistake is fishing it too fast. This rig catches fish while it is doing nothing. If you feel like you are wasting time, you are probably fishing it correctly.
- Watch the line

You will not feel most bites. You will see them. Keep a slight bow in the line and keep your eyes on where it enters the water.
- Wind

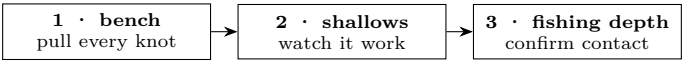
The one condition it hates. In a chop you cannot see the line; switch to a *see the Texas rig sheet* or a jig.
- Where

Pine spots **5**, **6** and **7** — especially in bright, calm, high-sun conditions when nothing else produces. North spots **1** and **7**.
- Hookset

A firm sweep, not a snap. The hook is exposed; it does not need to be driven through plastic.

When to use it
Bright sun, flat calm, clear water, pressured fish — exactly the conditions where everyone else stops catching. On Pine Lake in July this is the highest-percentage bass presentation on the sheet, and it takes ten seconds to tie.

Prove the rig



Bench test	Pull the knot, center the hook through the O-ring or exact worm midpoint, and compare both hanging ends for equal length.
Water test	Drop beside the boat: both ends must pulse independently while the worm falls level, not nose-first.
Proof at depth	Watch line angle and count sink time to the target depth; repeatable time is proof the bait is falling clean.
If it fails	One end dominates: recenter the hook. Worm tears: use an O-ring. No visible fall: shorten the cast or use high-visibility main line with a clear leader. Change one variable, repeat the same cast or drop, and keep the first setting that restores the expected proof.

Record the adjustment

Try	Depth / distance	Sink count	Observed action	Fish response	Next single change
1					
2					
3					

Questions before another cast

Did the rig reach the intended depth? What visible line, rod-tip, bottom, or lure response proves that? Did the connection and hook point survive the retrieve? Was a follow, bite, snag, or refusal observed rather than assumed? Name one variable to change and one to hold constant. If the observation cannot answer those questions, repeat the same short controlled cast before changing the setup.

☐ Sketch the cast: surface, cover, target depth, line angle, and where the response occurred

Evidence-based verdict ☐ repeat unchanged ☐ alter one variable ☐ retire or repair the rig

Reason and next prediction

Telos. Lake Country Fishing — Wacky Rig. Revised 2026-07-25. Project-created text and diagrams are licensed CC BY 4.0. Incorporated public-domain artwork remains public domain and is credited on the plate it appears with. See LICENSE and CREDITS.md in the source. Nothing here is professional advice; verify current regulations and follow the stated safety procedure.